Supported calf raise

Ankle plantarflexion / 8-12



START / heels down FINISH / controlled heel lift

MAIN: Gastrocnemius and soleus lift the heels.

SECONDARY: Other lower-leg and foot muscles control ankle alignment.

BASE / SUPPORT: Hip and trunk muscles keep the body upright; hands on a fixed support assist balance.

01 / Check the setup

Use a fixed counter or stable chair against a wall. Begin on a flat floor without extra resistance.

02 / Set the base and brace

Stand with feet about hip-width apart, weight shared between them and knees soft. Hold support lightly but securely.

03 / Move with control

Rise slowly onto the forefeet while keeping pressure across the ball of each foot; breathe normally.

04 / Limit the range and return

Lift only as high as you can stay balanced. Lower heels gently to the floor without bouncing.

WATCH FOR: Do not roll ankles outward, lean heavily forward or grip with the toes to force more height. EASIER: Use a smaller lift or do seated heel raises if standing support is uncomfortable.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: NHS - Strength exercises. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html